UPSC Civil Services Mains — General Studies Paper II

Governance, Constitution, Polity, Social Justice and International Relations

Syllabus outline for focused preparation

Constitution and Polity

• Indian Constitution—historical underpinnings, evolution, features, amendments, significant provisions and basic structure.

• Functions and responsibilities of the Union and the States, issues and challenges pertaining to the federal structure, devolution of powers and finances up to local levels and challenges therein.

• Separation of powers between various organs, dispute redressal mechanisms and institutions.

• Comparison of the Indian constitutional scheme with that of other countries.

• Parliament and State legislatures—structure, functioning, conduct of business, powers & privileges and issues arising out of these.

• Structure, organization and functioning of the Executive and the Judiciary—Ministries and Departments of the Government; pressure groups and formal/informal associations and their role in the Polity.

• Salient features of the Representation of People’s Act.

• Appointment to various Constitutional posts, powers, functions and responsibilities of various Constitutional Bodies.

• Statutory, regulatory and various quasi-judicial bodies.

Governance and Social Justice

• Government policies and interventions for development in various sectors and issues arising out of their design and implementation.

• Development processes and the development industry—the role of NGOs, SHGs, various groups and associations, donors, charities, institutional and other stakeholders.

• Welfare schemes for vulnerable sections of the population by the Centre and States and the performance of these schemes; mechanisms, laws, institutions and Bodies constituted for the protection and betterment of these vulnerable sections.

• Issues relating to development and management of Social Sector/Services relating to Health, Education, Human Resources.

• Issues relating to poverty and hunger.

Governance

• Important aspects of governance, transparency and accountability, e-governance—applications, models, successes, limitations, and potential; citizens’ charters, transparency & accountability and institutional and other measures.

• Role of civil services in a democracy.

International Relations

• India and its neighbourhood—relations.

• Bilateral, regional and global groupings and agreements involving India and/or affecting India’s interests.

- Effect of policies and politics of developed and developing countries on India’s interests, Indian diaspora.
- Important International institutions, agencies and fora—their structure, mandate.

Reference: UPSC Civil Services (Main) Examination syllabus. Verify against the latest official UPSC notification for any amendments.